NO PRACHARAKS FOR BJP



In the RSS-BJP ecosystem, some signals are only for the knowing eyes. For nearly two years now, the Sangh under general secretary **Dattatreya Hosabale** has quietly frozen the deputation of pracharaks to the BJP. Eight key states still lack a full-time general secretar (organisation), despite the part pushing for more appointees. Sources say that within the Sar there is growing unease over pracharaks being drawn into the political vortex, diluting their ideological core and, worse, fuelling political ambitions. Hosabale's message is clear—we support the party, but we don't want to become its staffing arm.

ALL THE BEST



On March 15, West Bengal CM **Mamata Banerjee** fired off a sharp letter to chief election commissioner **Gyanesh Kumar**, protesting the EC's administrative reshuffle in the poll-bound state. At the end, she wrote: "All the best." When flummoxed reporters asked her why, she said the Commission was doing as it pleased, so she wished it luck. Somewhere between courtesy and provocation, the comment was more a 'do your worst, *khela hobe*' dare, say insiders.

PRIVILEGED TRESPASS



BJP parliamentarian **Nishikant Dubey** found himself in an unholy row after his Bhimashankar temple run in Pune on March 14. The reason? The temple, which houses a jyotirlinga of Lord Shiva, has been closed for repairs since January, with devotees not allowed darshan even on Mahashivaratri day. So, who let Dubey in? The public outrage led to the district administration ordering a probe and asking the temple trust for an explanation. But then VIP privilege has never been a matter of secret in this country.

Kaushik Deka with Anilesh S. Mahajan, Prasad Nichenametla, Amitabh Srivastava, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar and Dhaval S. Kulkarni

HEALTH WATCH

NUTRACEUTICALS
NANO TECH, BIG BENEFITS

By **Sonali Acharjee**

India's nutraceutical industry is beginning to experiment with nanotechnology, with several companies recently launching high-absorption curcumin, Vitamin D, Omega-3 and herbal supplements. This reflects a larger trend in preventive healthcare, where nutrition is becoming more science-driven and targeted rather than generic supplementation.

In India, this technology is being explored not just for supplements but also for functional foods, immunity drinks and fortified foods. Startups and nutraceutical manufacturers are focusing on nano-curcumin, nano-vitamins, herbal extracts and antioxidant formulations aimed at lifestyle diseases, ageing, immunity and metabolic health. The nutraceuticals market was worth some $6 billion (Rs 55,957 crore) in 2024 and could be worth double by 2030.



Nano-nutraceuticals are essentially nutrients or plant compounds delivered using nano particles, nano-emulsions or nano-capsules that improve the way the body absorbs them. Many popular health ingredients such as turmeric, resveratrol and iron have low absorption in their normal form. Nano-delivery systems can boost bioavailability significantly, meaning smaller doses could be more effective.

For consumers, the long-term significance is important. As India faces rising diabetes, heart disease and obesity, nano-neutraceuticals could make preventive nutrition more effective, personalised and medically relevant—potentially blurring the line between food and medicine in the coming decade.